

CO.4 Where to File Directory

How to pin down which offices own your parcel — including the Division's own published lists of who inspects electrical and plumbing where — plus a page to write down what you confirmed.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Colorado adopts no statewide residential building code: each county and each municipality decides for itself whether to require a building permit and which code edition to enforce, and a few counties require no building permit at all. Electrical and plumbing run on a separate, statewide track. Confirm every item with the office that will actually issue it before you rely on it.

SETTLE THREE QUESTIONS, NOT ONE

Everything in this kit branches on three independent answers. **(1) Does a building permit exist for my parcel, and from whom?** — a county or municipal question, and in a few Colorado counties the answer is none. **(2) Who issues my electrical permit?** **(3) Who issues my plumbing and gas piping permit?** Questions 2 and 3 run on different statutory tests and have genuinely different answers in ten Colorado counties — asking once and assuming twice is the classic mistake.

Get it in writing, from the office that will issue it

Ask the county or city planning and building office: *"Is this parcel inside a municipality or unincorporated? Do you require a building permit for a new single-family dwelling? Which code editions have you adopted, and do you run your own electrical and plumbing inspection programs?"* Then check the trade answers against the Division's published lists below. If the two disagree, resolve it before you buy a permit.

THE DIVISION'S PUBLISHED LISTS — WHO DOES NOT USE THE STATE

The Division of Professions and Occupations publishes, on its permits page, the jurisdictions that run their own inspection programs. Its instruction is that if your county appears on the relevant list, you *"do not continue with the permit application process"* and go to the local jurisdiction instead — and that **"You are responsible for determining the correct inspection authority."** Transcribed as published in August 2026:

Jurisdictions the State does NOT inspect (as published, August 2026)

Trade	Counties and areas running their own program
Electrical local program	Adams (except Federal Heights) · Arapahoe (except Bow Mar, Deer Trail, and Sheridan city limits) · Boulder · Broomfield · Chaffee · City of Pueblo and Town of Boone · Delta (City of Delta only) · Denver · Douglas · Eagle (except Minturn and Town of Avon) · El Paso · Jefferson · Larimer · Mesa · Pitkin · Pueblo · Routt · San Miguel (Telluride and Mountain Village) · Summit · Teller · Weld
Plumbing local program	Adams (except Federal Heights) · Arapahoe (except Bow Mar and Sheridan city limits) · Boulder · Broomfield · Chaffee · City of Pueblo and Town of Boone · Clear Creek · Denver · Douglas · Eagle · El Paso · Elbert · Garfield · Gilpin · Grand · Jackson · Jefferson · La Plata · Lake · Larimer · Mesa · Moffat · Pitkin · Prowers · Pueblo · Routt · Summit · Teller · Weld

Read the two lists against each other

Ten counties appear on the plumbing list but not the electrical one — Clear Creek, Elbert, Garfield, Gilpin, Grand, Jackson, La Plata, Lake, Moffat, and Prowers (bolded above). Build in any of them and you take your plumbing permit to the county and your **electrical permit to the State**, with two different inspectors on two different schedules. It runs the other way too: **Delta (City of Delta only)** and **San Miguel (Telluride and Mountain Village)** appear for electrical but not plumbing. And the exceptions are per-town — Federal Heights inside Adams, Minturn and Avon inside Eagle for electrical, Deer Trail inside Arapahoe for electrical but not plumbing. This is the whole thesis of the kit on one page.

This list moves — and the statute says when

A local government may start or stop running its own electrical inspection program *"only as of July 1 of any year,"* with written notice to the board *"on or before October 1 of the preceding calendar year"* (C.R.S. 12-115-120(8)). The plumbing statute requires written notice but sets no comparable date (12-155-120(6)). So: treat the lists above as a dated snapshot, **re-check them at dpo.colorado.gov before you buy any permit**, and be especially careful with a project that straddles a July 1.

STATE OFFICES — WHO OWNS WHICH PIECE

State offices and what each is actually for

Office	Why you would go there	Website
DPO — Electrical & Plumbing Permits	Buy the state electrical, plumbing, and gas piping permits; the local-jurisdiction lists above; inspection maps and inspector contact lists; the homeowner permit route and guides.	dpo.colorado.gov → Electrical & Plumbing Permits

State offices and what each is actually for

Office	Why you would go there	Website
State Electrical Board	The adopted NEC edition and its effective date (board rules, 3 CCR 710-1), licensing, variances, rulemaking notices.	dpo.colorado.gov/Electrical
State Plumbing Board	The Colorado Plumbing Code and Colorado Fuel Gas Code as adopted (board rules, 3 CCR 720-1), plumbing licensing, and variances.	dpo.colorado.gov/Plumbing
DORA license lookup	Verify any electrician or plumber you hire, and confirm the firm's contractor registration, before they touch the job.	dora.colorado.gov
Division of Water Resources	Well permits and the eForms dashboard; the Beginner's Guide to Well Permits; permit search and map viewer; Designated Basin and Denver Basin rules.	dwr.colorado.gov
Your local public health agency	The OWTS (septic) permit, site evaluation, local OWTS rules, and the final inspection. Primary enforcement sits here, not with the state (25-10-110).	County or district public health
Division of Fire Prevention and Control	The 2025 Colorado Wildfire Resiliency Code — structure hardening and site requirements that apply " <i>within the wildland-urban interface areas of Colorado, as designated in this code,</i> " plus the mapping and the petition process for code variations.	dfpc.colorado.gov
Colorado Energy Office	The model electric ready and solar ready code and the model low energy and carbon code that the energy-code triggers in CO.2 point at.	energyoffice.colorado.gov
Secretary of State — CCR	The Code of Colorado Regulations: the official text of every board rule cited in this kit, with each past version and its effective date.	sos.state.co.us/CCR

Domains from each agency's own site navigation, read August 2026. This kit prints no phone numbers — numbers rot; write the one you confirmed in the directory below.

WHO PERMITS YOUR PARCEL — TWO THINGS TO EXPECT

The Division's permits page links straight to the local jurisdictions it hands you off to — rare local URLs with a state agency standing behind them: **denvergov.org**, **jeffco.us**, **bouldercounty.gov**, **adcogov.org**, **pitkincounty.com**, **co.grand.co.us**, **co.laplata.co.us**, **jacksoncountycogov.gov**, **co.teller.co.us**, **cityofdelta.net**. Each department's own page governs — and two structural surprises are worth expecting.

A Colorado peculiarity: regional building departments

In parts of Colorado the permit authority is neither the city nor the county but a **regional building department** serving several governments at once. The largest is the **Pikes Peak Regional Building Department** (pprbd.org), which issues permits for unincorporated El Paso County; the cities of Colorado Springs, Fountain, and Manitou Springs; the towns of Green Mountain Falls, Monument, and Palmer Lake; and, in Teller County, Woodland Park only. Its own pages currently disagree about whether Calhan is served — the site header lists it, the homeowner page excludes it — so near a boundary, get the answer in writing.

And these departments themselves change. The Pueblo Regional Building Department was succeeded effective **January 1, 2026**: Pueblo city limits and the Town of Boone now go to the **Southern Colorado Building Department** (socobd.com), the rest of the county including Pueblo West to the **Pueblo County Building Division** (pueblopermits.com). Older guides — and some state pages — still link to the predecessor.

FINDING THE REST

Finding the right office for your parcel

Office	How to find it
Local public health (septic)	Search "[your county] CO public health onsite wastewater" — some counties run their own agency, others belong to a health district. Every local board of health must have adopted OWTS rules (25-10-104(2)); ask for them.
Your state inspector	Not the Division switchboard — use the inspection map and inspector contact list on the Division's permits page, and note the name in the block below when you buy the permit.
Water provider or well	For a tap, the municipality or water and sanitation district serving the parcel — ask for a written will-serve. For a well, DWR's permit search and map viewer show what neighboring parcels hold.
Road authority and fire district	County road and bridge, the municipality, or CDOT where the driveway meets a state highway — confirm which owns your frontage before you cut it. The fire district is usually yet another special district, with its own access, water-supply, and defensible-space rules. Find both by parcel, early.

YOUR DIRECTORY — FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU NEED IT

Confirm each entry by phone rather than copying it from a search result, and write the date. In a small county office, a name is worth more than a number.

BUILDING PERMIT OFFICE — county, municipality, or regional building department — and whether a permit is required at all

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ELECTRICAL PERMIT + INSPECTOR — state or local; inspector's name and number from the contact list

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

PLUMBING / GAS PERMIT + INSPECTOR — asked separately — the answer can differ from electrical

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

LOCAL PUBLIC HEALTH — OWTS — septic permit, site evaluation, final inspection

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

WATER — DWR, DRILLER, OR PROVIDER — well permit (allow up to 49 days for review), or the will-serve letter for a tap

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ROAD AUTHORITY / ADDRESSING — driveway permit — county, city, or CDOT — and the assigned address

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

FIRE DISTRICT / WILDFIRE — access, water supply, defensible space; who reviews for the Wildfire Resiliency Code

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ELECTRIC UTILITY — line extension, temporary power, meter set — no permanent service without the final electrical approval

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

Sources (verified August 2026): jurisdiction lists, homeowner permit route, and inspector contact lists — dpo.colorado.gov/ElectricalPlumbingPermits, transcribed as published. Change cadence — C.R.S. 12-115-120(8), 12-155-120(6). Local OWTS rules and enforcement — 25-10-104(2), 25-10-110. Wells — dwr.colorado.gov. Pueblo Regional Building Department — prbd.com.